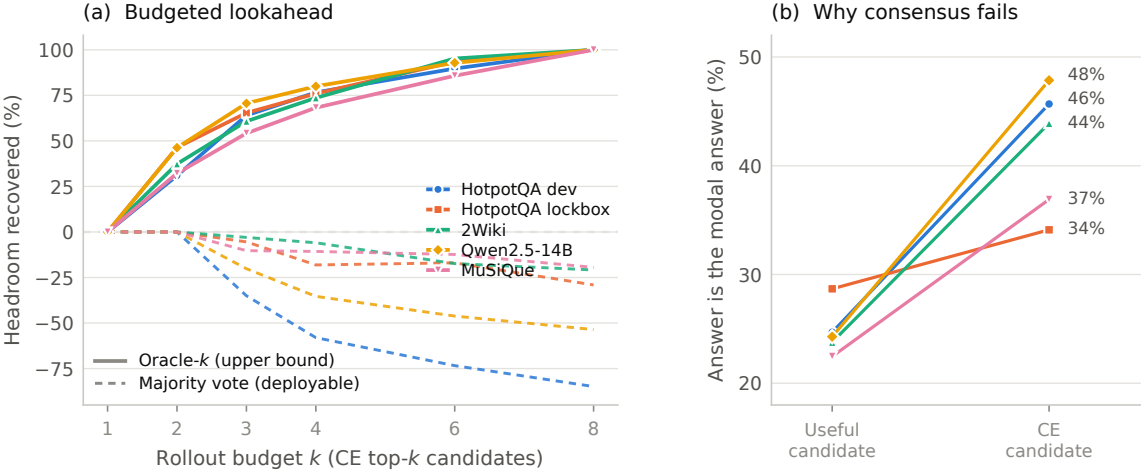
(a) Budgeted lookahead
Headroom recovered (%)
100
75
50
25
0
−25
−50
−75
1
2
3
4
6
8
Rollout budget k (CE top-k candidates)
HotpotQA dev
HotpotQA lockbox
2Wiki
Qwen2.5-14B
MuSiQue
Oracle-k (upper bound)
Majority vote (deployable)
(b) Why consensus fails
Answer is the modal answer (%)
50
40
30
20
48%
46%
44%
37%
34%
Useful candidate
CE candidate